

An Analysis of Bahrain's Fast Fashion Import Trends 2021-2025



ROVE

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Gulf Insights Consulting is a data-driven consultancy firm specializing in market research and business intelligence across the **GCC**. Our team of analysts combines strong analytical skills with regional expertise to deliver clear and actionable insights.

In this project, we are supporting our client in starting a business in Bahrain by analyzing **clothing import data from 2021 to 2025—identifying high-demand categories**, key supplier countries, cost-effective sourcing options, and potential market gaps to enable a successful market entry.



Client Persona



Who He Is

A Bahraini entrepreneur with a business background and experience in apparel retail, having previously worked as an operations supervisor in the fashion sector.

Hassan Ali

What He's Building

He is launching ROVE, a fast fashion brand focused on offering affordable, trend-driven clothing that targets the local market with globally inspired styles

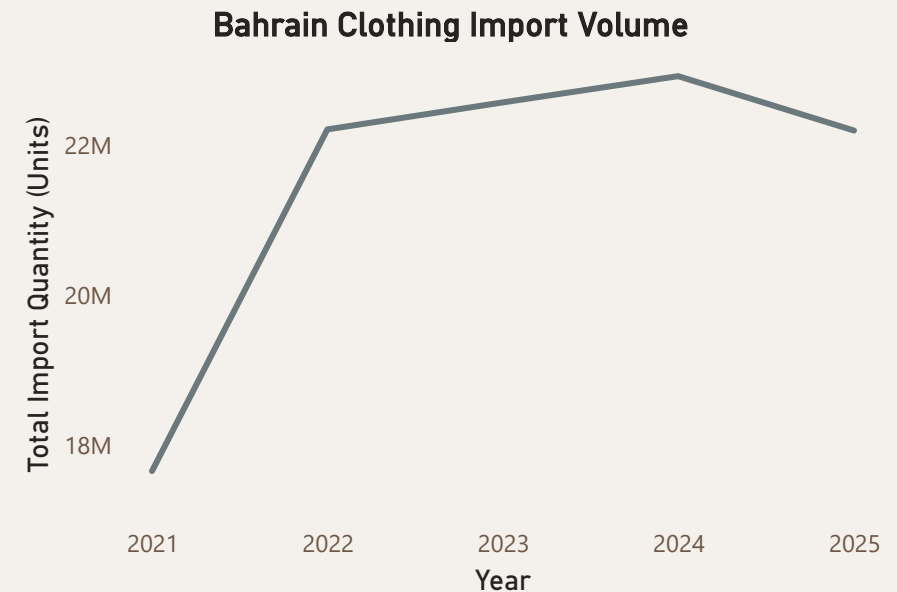
The Problem

Despite his operational experience, Hassan lacks clear visibility into which clothing categories are driving import demand, how trends have evolved between 2021 and 2025, and which sourcing markets dominate Bahrain's supply

Objectives

- Identify the highest-demand clothing categories based on import volume and value.
- Analyze import trends from 2021 to 2025 to detect growth patterns.
- Determine the main countries supplying clothing to Bahrain.
- Identify which sourcing countries offer the most affordable cost per item
- Evaluate potential market gaps or underserved product segments.

Big Picture



Bahrain's clothing market grew by nearly 40% in value since 2021

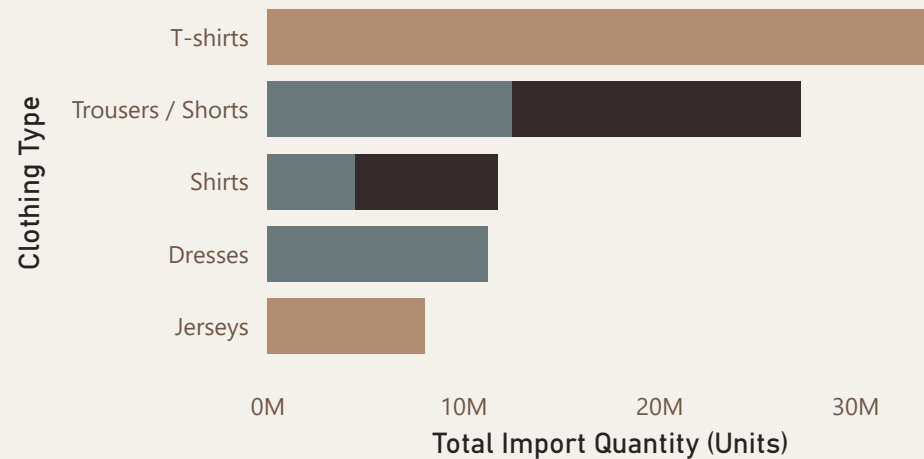
Bahrain imported nearly 392M BD worth of clothing over 4 years

The 2025 decline is small relative to overall market growth

Commodity analysis

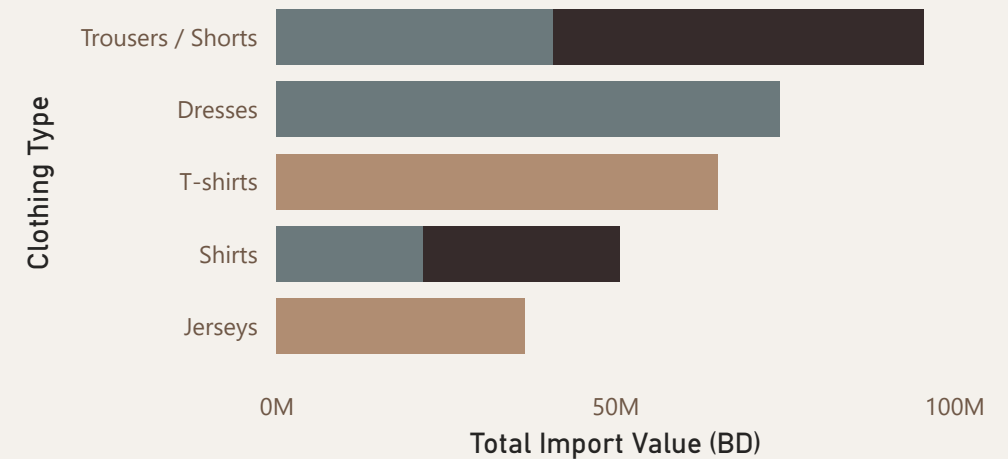
Top Clothing Types by Import Quantity

Gender ● Female ● Male ● Unisex / Other



Top Clothing Types by Import Value

Gender ● Female ● Male ● Unisex / Other



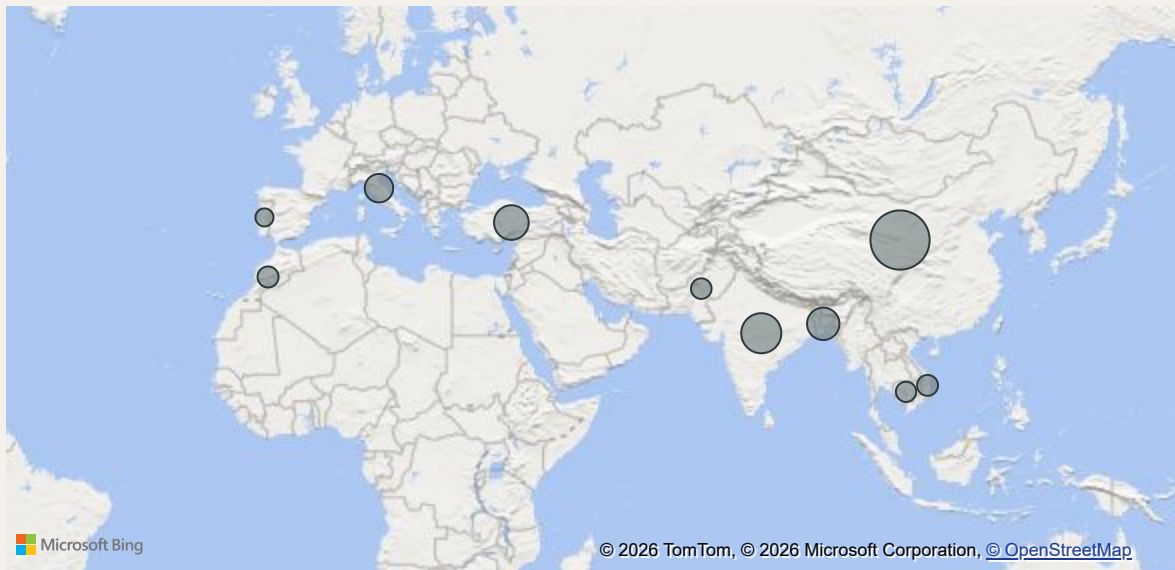
T-shirts are high volume, low cost items, likely mass market basics.

Trousers/Shorts is the most commercially significant category

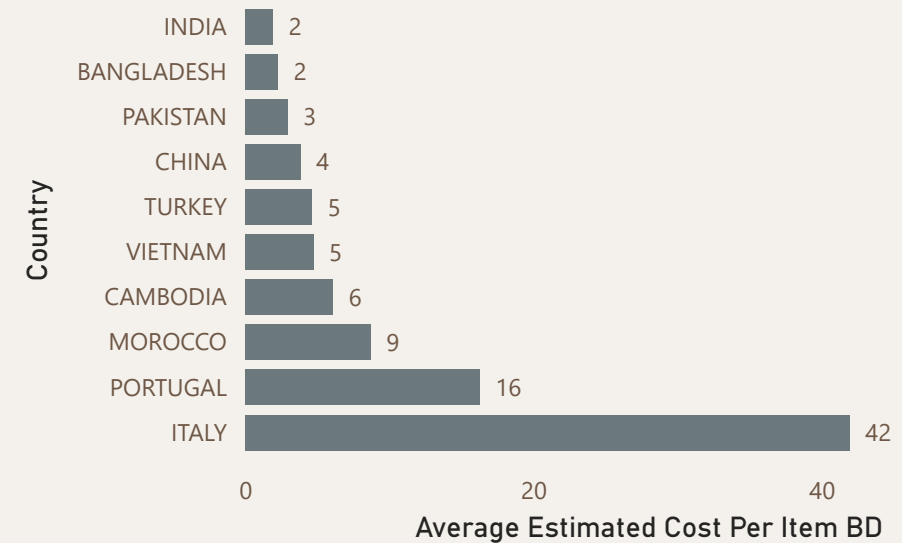
Women's dresses represent a niche, premium opportunity

Country Analysis

Top 10 Sources of Clothing Imports to Bahrain by Value



Bahrain's Most Affordable Clothing Sources



Asia dominates Bahrain's clothing supply chain

India and Bangladesh are the most affordable sourcing options

Italy and Portugal serve the premium end

Import Regulations Bahrain

- Goods must be **declared electronically** with key documents (invoice, bill of lading).
- Shipments undergo **customs inspection and risk-based checks** before release.
- Importers need a **valid Commercial Registration (CR)** and customs registration.
- Most goods are subject to **duties ($\approx 5\%$) and VAT**.
- Some items require **permits or No Objection Certificates (NOC)**.
- Clothing must meet **labeling and compliance standards**.



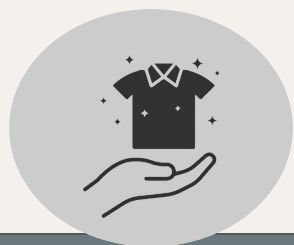
Shipping & Logistics to Bahrain (Summary)

- **Sea freight (bulk):** ~\$1,200 – \$2,500 per 20ft container
- **Air freight:** ~\$4 – \$8 per kg (faster, higher cost)
- **LCL (small shipments):** ~\$40 – \$100 per CBM
 - **Transit time:** China → Bahrain: **20–35 days**
 - India/Bangladesh → Bahrain: ~**15–30 days**
- **Key costs include:** freight, customs duty (~5% + VAT), port & handling fees

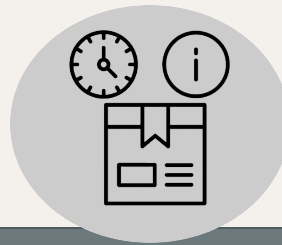
Insight: Sea freight is most cost-effective for bulk clothing imports.



Recommendation



Lead with T-shirts, Trousers, and Dresses These three categories consistently dominate import value across all seasons in Bahrain.



Time inventory builds around January–March and December Import values peak during these months — order from suppliers in October and November.



Source core products from India or Bangladesh to keep costs low, while exploring China for variety.



Bahrain Imports 2021-2025

Import Value (BD)

391.61M

Select a season

Total Quantity

107.54M

Select a season

Avg Price / Unit (BD)

3.64

Select a season

Total Import Weight (KG)

45.89M

Select a season

Top Sourcing Country

CHINA

by import
quantity 107.54M

All

Winter

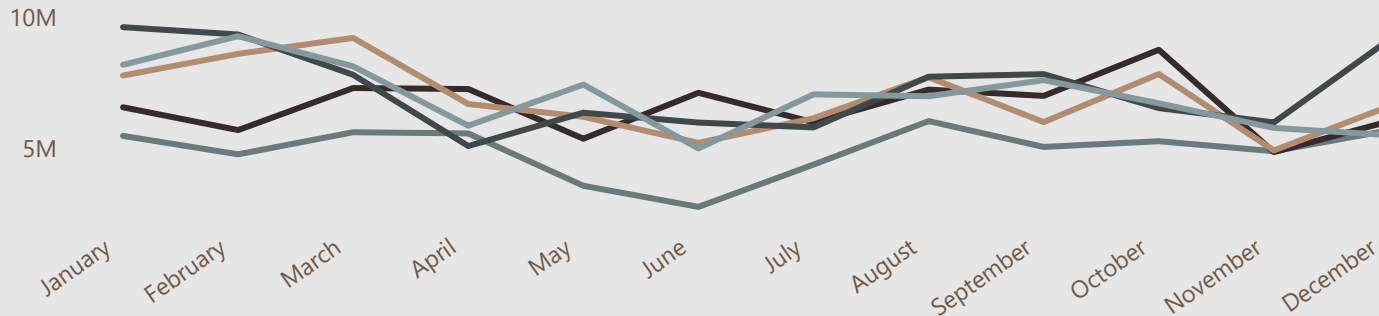
Spring

Summer

Fall

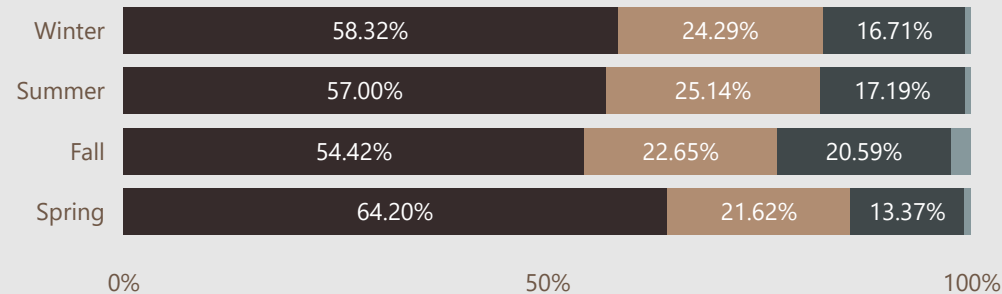
Monthly import trend (BD) by year

year ● 2021 ● 2022 ● 2023 ● 2024 ● 2025



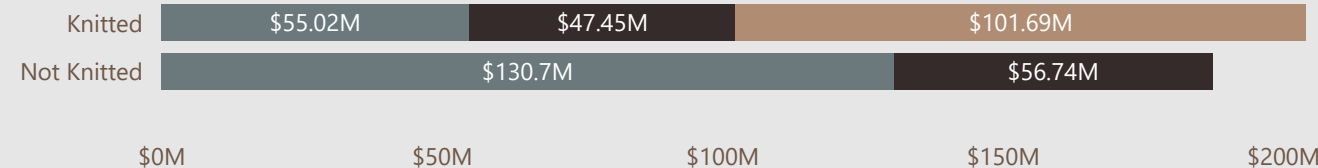
Fabric mix by season

Fabric Type ● Cashmere ● Cotton ● Other ● Synthetic ● Wool



Import Value by Construction & Gender (BD)

Gender ● Female ● Male ● Unisex / Other



Clothing type * season heatmap

Clothing Type	Fall	Spring	Summer	Winter
Underwear	105,530	157,811	335,218	394,759
T-shirts	8,778,711	10,996,958	22,351,855	22,929,010
Trousers / Shorts	13,761,767	15,276,397	31,783,713	34,702,694
Suits	1,238,836	1,142,862	2,208,076	3,157,855
Slips	70,949	43,813	127,217	118,864

Limitations

No visual/style classification: The dataset contains no images or style descriptors — we could not determine whether imported garments are casual, formal, luxury, or streetwear. This made it difficult to define the client's brand positioning visually.

No retail price data: Import values reflect wholesale/landed costs only — we have no visibility into retail markups or consumer pricing in Bahrain, which limits pricing strategy recommendations.

No gender demand data: Gender classification was derived from commodity descriptions only — there is no consumer demand data to validate whether male or female fashion actually sells better in Bahrain